UX RESEARCH · LUXURY REAL ESTATE

What wealthy buyers *really need.*

Desk research of 2026 market reports on high-net-worth buyers and the Phuket villa market. Each insight links to the design decision it drove and the screens where it shows up. Primary research (interviews and usability tests) is planned below to validate the personas.

RESEARCH GOALS
- Understand how HNW buyers search, shortlist and decide on a luxury home
- Identify trust and legal barriers for foreign buyers in Thailand
- Find where an app beats a human advisor, and where it must hand over

METHODS · DONE
- Desk research: 2026 luxury market and wealth reports
- Competitive scan of luxury portals and agency apps
- Proto-personas built from the evidence (35–37)

METHODS · PLANNED
- 10 in-depth interviews: Thai and foreign buyers, 2 sellers
- 5 interviews with private advisors and luxury agents
- Usability test of the 30-screen prototype, 5 users per round

KEY INSIGHTS → DESIGN DECISIONS

Insight 01

Privacy is a requirement, not a perk

Top-tier buyers increasingly expect discretion and want first look at exceptional stock before it reaches public portals.

Source: Lucas Fox, 2025

DESIGN RESPONSE · SCREENS 19 · 16 · 29
Off-market tier, identity hidden from sellers, advisor-led introductions.

Insight 02

Buyers refuse to compromise

51%

Coldwell Banker specialists (May 2026) who say luxury buyers rarely make trade-offs at closing.

Source: Coldwell Banker Global Luxury, 2026

DESIGN RESPONSE · SCREENS 08 · 17
Precise filters (view, land, privacy) and side-by-side compare instead of broad search.

Insight 03

The first viewing happens on a screen

77%

Luxury buyers who want a virtual experience before visiting in person (Coldwell Banker survey, via Entrepreneur).

Source: Million Luxury, 2026

DESIGN RESPONSE · SCREENS 12 · 13 · 20
Gallery tabs, floor plans, 3D tour and private video-call viewings.

Insight 04

Phuket luxury is an international market

~50%

Approximate share of Phuket luxury landed transactions made by foreign buyers in Q1 2026.

Source: Asia Lifestyle Magazine, 2026

DESIGN RESPONSE · SCREENS 18 · 29
English-first UI, multi-currency, multilingual advisors, remote-friendly flow.

Insight 05

Legal certainty decides the deal

2026

Thailand's nominee-structure crackdown led many foreign villa buyers to pause and re-examine ownership structures.

Source: SCMP · EdgeProp, Jun 2026

DESIGN RESPONSE · SCREENS 11 · 24 · 25
Verified title badge, ownership-structure disclosure, document vault and e-sign.

Insight 06

Many pay in cash, investors want returns

68%

Share of Phuket villa buyers who bought for investment rather than own use (Bangkok Post).

Source: The Phuket News, 2025

DESIGN RESPONSE · SCREENS 15 · 22
Cash as default offer method; mortgage tool as secondary; yield insights for investors.

HOW MIGHT WE…

How might we give buyers off-market access without exposing sellers?

How might we make a villa feel real before a flight is booked?

How might we prove ownership is legally clean in one glance?

How might we keep a human advisor one tap away at every step?

UX RESEARCH · PERSONAS

Who we *design for.*

Three proto-personas built from the desk research on board 34: a Thai lifestyle buyer, a remote foreign investor and a discreet seller. Validate with the planned interviews before treating them as final.

PERSONA 01 · PRIMARY — Proto-persona · to validate

PS

Pat Srisawat

42 · Founder, fintech group · Bangkok

LIFESTYLE BUYER · THAI

> *"I don't have time to browse. Show me the three homes that are right, and keep my name out of it."*

Built and sold a company; wants a Phuket pool villa for family holidays and eventually part-time living. Budget ฿150–200M, paying cash. Delegates search to people he trusts.

GOALS
- A sea-view villa ready to use within 6 months
- One advisor who knows his taste
- A fast, private process with no surprises

FRUSTRATIONS
- Portals full of mismatched listings
- Agents who share his details too widely
- Flying down for viewings that disappoint

Need for privacy (Low – High) · Tech comfort (Low – High) · Price sensitivity (Low – High) · Need for an advisor (Self-serve – Hands-on)

BEHAVIOURS
- Searches late evening on mobile
- Decides with spouse; shares shortlists
- Prefers chat over calls

WHAT AURELLE GIVES THEM · SCREENS 06 · 16 · 19 · 20
Curated feed · Off-market access · Advisor chat · Chauffeured viewing

PERSONA 02 · SECONDARY — Proto-persona · to validate

VL

Vivian Lau

46 · Family-office director · Hong Kong

REMOTE INVESTOR · FOREIGN

> *"Before I fly anywhere, I need the floor plan, the title and the yield in front of me."*

Manages property for a family office. Buying a Phuket villa mainly as an investment with rental income, plus a few weeks of family use. Has never seen the island's villa estates in person.

GOALS
- A legally clean structure she can defend to the family
- Credible rental-yield picture
- Close the deal remotely where possible

FRUSTRATIONS
- Unclear leasehold and company structures
- Glossy photos with no floor plans
- Time-zone gaps with local agents

Need for privacy (Low – High) · Tech comfort (Low – High) · Price sensitivity (Low – High) · Need for an advisor (Self-serve – Hands-on)

BEHAVIOURS
- Researches on laptop, approves on phone
- Forwards documents to lawyers
- Books video viewings first

WHAT AURELLE GIVES THEM · SCREENS 12 · 13 · 17 · 24 · 25
Verified title · Documents & e-sign · 3D tour · Compare · Mortgage/yield

PERSONA 03 · SELLER — Proto-persona · to validate

AC

Anan Chaiyaporn

63 · Retired industrialist · Hua Hin

DISCREET SELLER · THAI

> *"I want a fair price from a serious buyer. I don't want my house on every website."*

Owns a large beachfront estate he no longer uses. Wants to sell quietly to downsize and pass wealth to his children, without public price cuts or strangers touring the home.

GOALS
- An honest valuation from a specialist
- Only qualified, verified buyers
- A sale without publicity

FRUSTRATIONS
- Public listings that reveal his address
- Time-wasting viewings
- Complex paperwork

Need for privacy (Low – High) · Tech comfort (Low – High) · Price sensitivity (Low – High) · Need for an advisor (Self-serve – Hands-on)

BEHAVIOURS
- Uses LINE and phone calls
- Relies on his children for apps
- Values in-person meetings

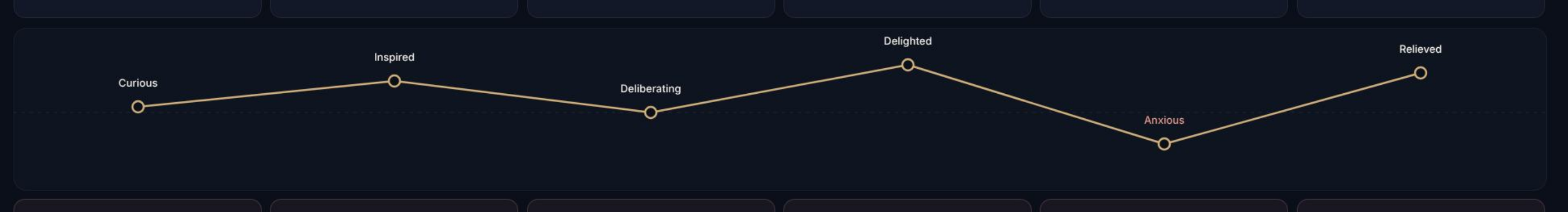
WHAT AURELLE GIVES THEM · SCREENS 30 · 18 · 19
Private valuation · Off-market listing · Advisor-managed viewings

UX RESEARCH · CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP

From first look to *keys in hand.*

PERSONA

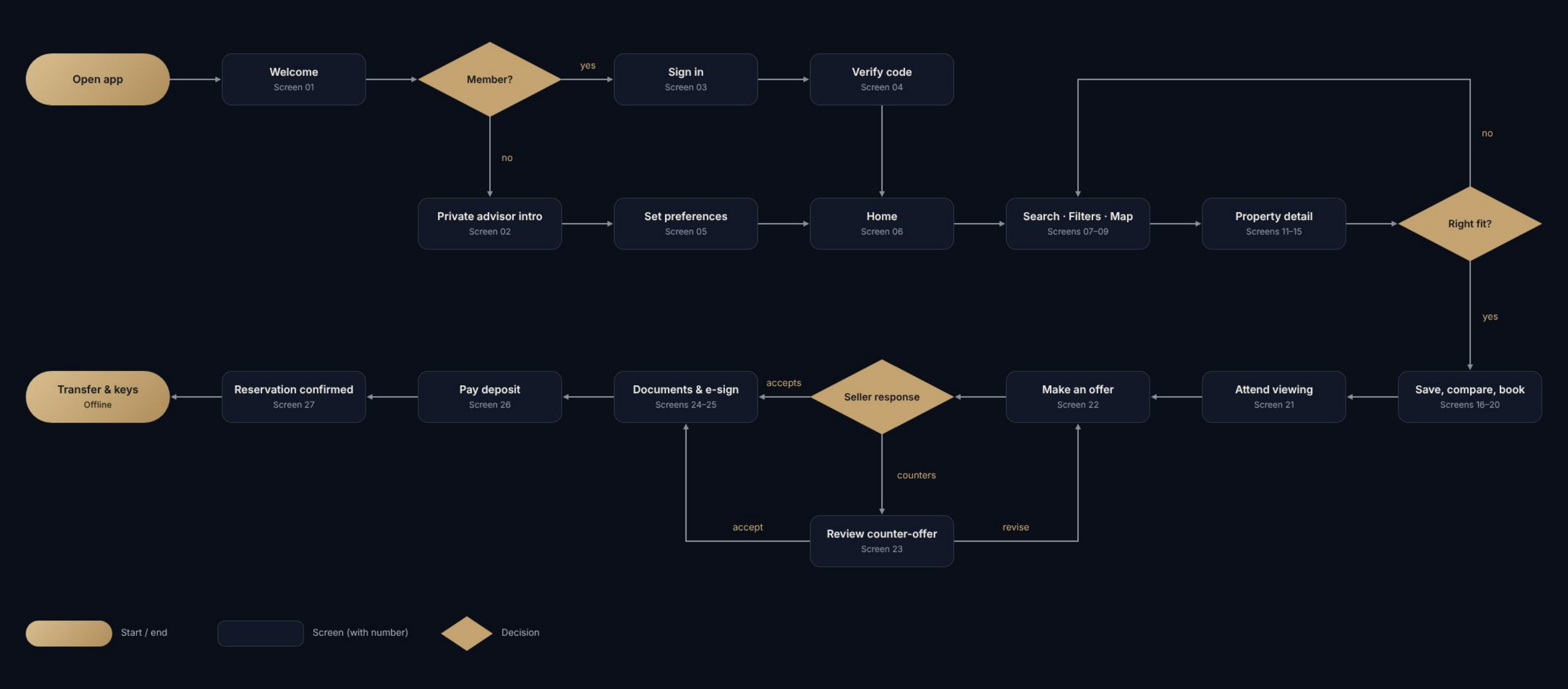
PS **Pat Srisawat, 42 · Founder, Bangkok**
Buying a holiday pool villa in Phuket, budget ฿150–200M. Values privacy, speed and a trusted advisor over browsing.

	STAGE 01 · SCREENS 01–10 Discover	STAGE 02 · SCREENS 11–15 Explore	STAGE 03 · SCREENS 16–20 Shortlist	STAGE 04 · SCREENS 20–21 View	STAGE 05 · SCREENS 22–23 Offer	STAGE 06 · SCREENS 24–27 Close
GOAL	Find homes that fit my brief, fast	Judge a home without flying in	Narrow down to the best two or three	Feel the home in person	Pay a fair price, not overpay	Secure it safely and simply
ACTIONS	Sets preferences, searches, filters, scans the map	Browses gallery, floor plan, location, mortgage	Saves, compares, chats with advisor	Books a slot, takes chauffeur, tours the villa	Submits offer, tracks seller response	Uploads documents, e-signs, pays deposit
TOUCHPOINTS	Welcome · Preferences · Home · Search · Map	Detail · Gallery · Features · Location · Mortgage	Saved · Compare · Advisor · Chat	Book a viewing · My viewings	Make an offer · Offer status	Documents · Sign · Deposit · Confirmed
THINKING	*"Is this only the public listings?"*	*"Is the view really like the photos?"*	*"Which of these is better value?"*	*"This is the one."*	*"Will they accept? Am I too low?"*	*"Is my money safe in this process?"*
EMOTION Higher is better	Curious	Inspired	Deliberating	Delighted	Anxious	Relieved
PAIN POINTS	Generic portals mix luxury with mass-market	Photos alone do not convey scale or light	Hard to compare unlike properties	Coordinating travel and access	Silence while waiting for the seller	Paperwork, foreign rules, large transfers
OPPORTUNITIES	Off-market access and a tailored feed	Floor plans, gallery tabs and 3D tour	Side-by-side compare with value highlights	One-tap booking with chauffeur	Live status timeline and countdown	Escrow deposit, e-sign, clear next steps

UX · USER FLOW

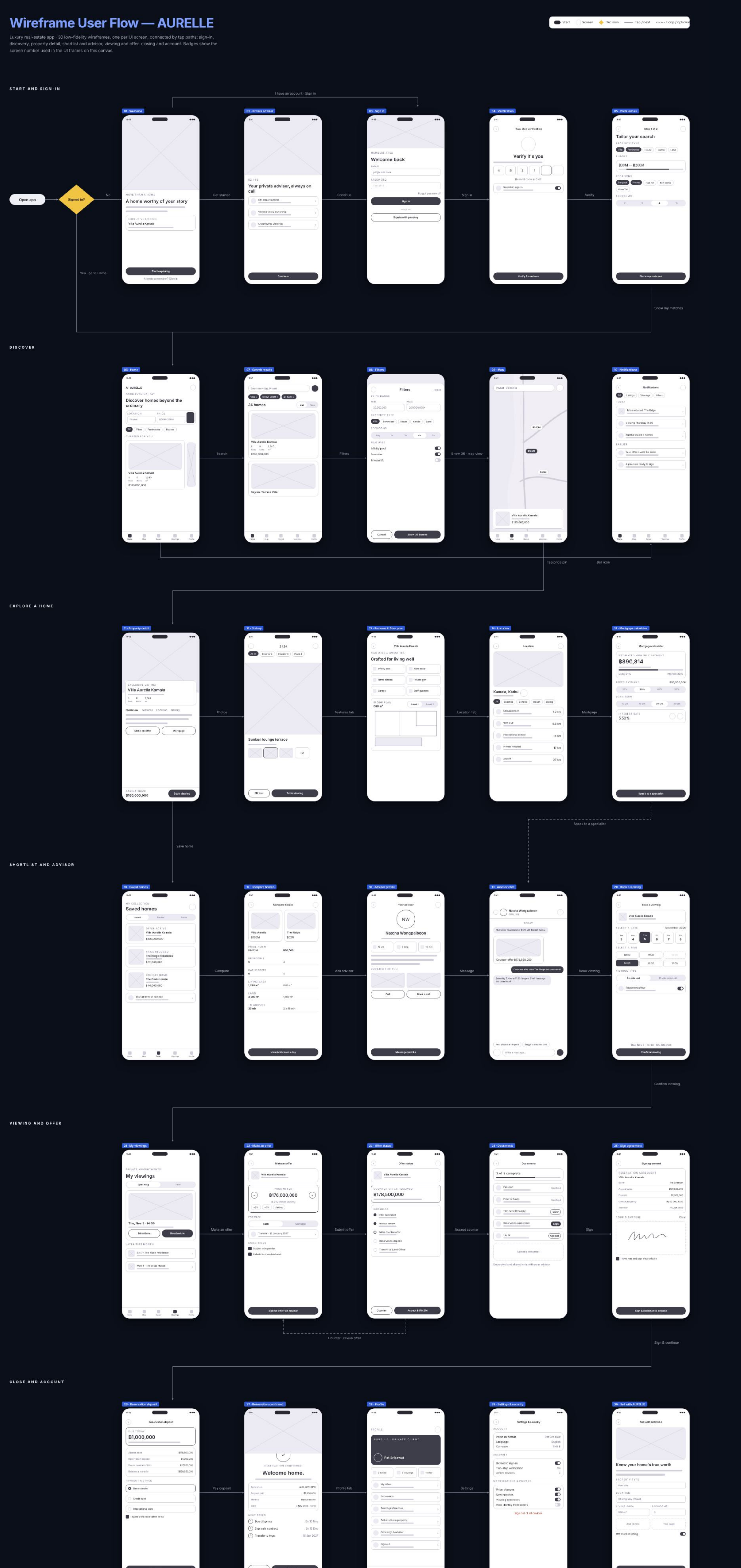
Primary purchase journey

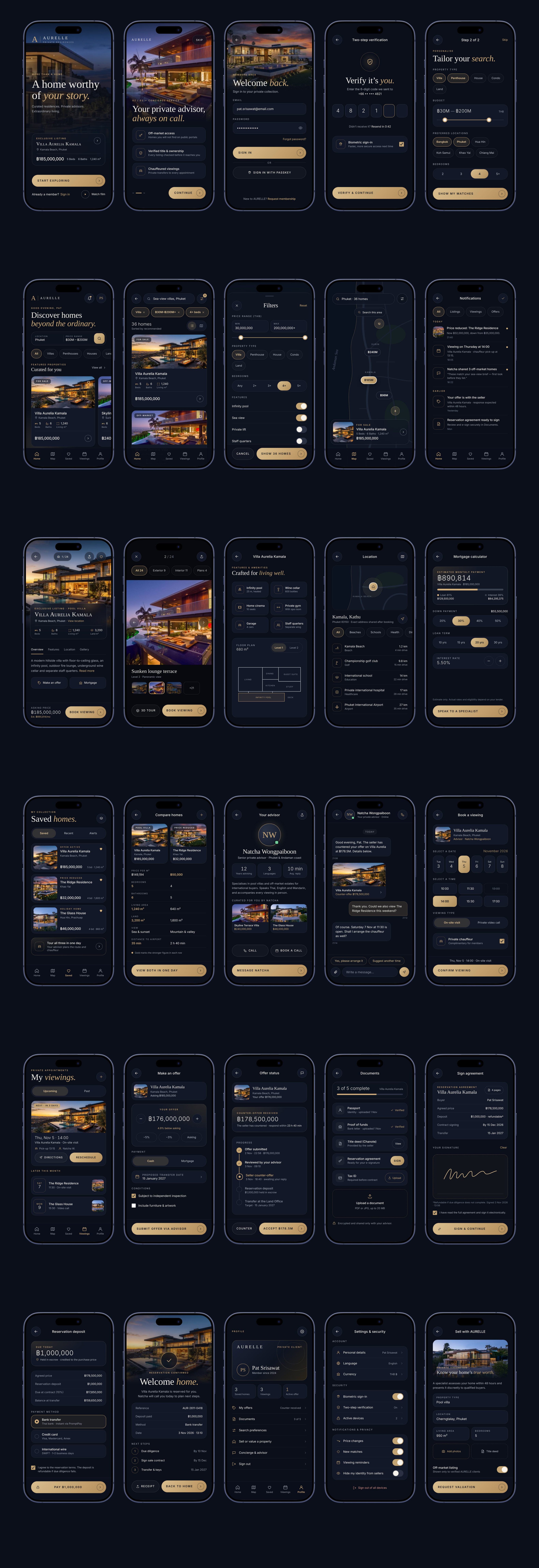
Happy path runs left to right, then right to left after the viewing. Gold diamonds are decisions; the loop above returns buyers to search when a home is not the right fit.


Open app
Welcome
Screen 01
Member?
yes
no
Sign in
Screen 03
Verify code
Screen 04
Private advisor intro
Screen 02
Set preferences
Screen 05
Home
Screen 06
Search · Filters · Map
Screens 07–09
Property detail
Screens 11–15
Right fit?
no
yes
Save, compare, book
Screens 16–20
Attend viewing
Screen 21
Make an offer
Screen 22
Seller response
accepts
counters
Review counter-offer
Screen 23
accept
revise
Documents & e-sign
Screens 24–25
Pay deposit
Screen 26
Reservation confirmed
Screen 27
Transfer & keys
Offline
Start / end
Screen (with number)
Decision

Wireframe User Flow — AURELLE

Luxury real-estate app · 30 low-fidelity wireframes, one per UI screen, connected by tap paths: sign-in, discovery, property detail, shortlist and advisor, viewing and offer, closing and account. Badges show the screen number used in the UI frames on this canvas.


Start
Screen
Decision
Tap / next
Loop / optional
START AND SIGN-IN
Open app
Signed in?
No
Yes · go to Home
I have an account · Sign in
01 · Welcome
Get started
02 · Private advisor
Continue
03 · Sign in
Sign in
04 · Verification
Verify
05 · Preferences
Show my matches
DISCOVER
06 · Home
Search
07 · Search results
Filters
08 · Filters
Show 36 · map view
09 · Map
10 · Notifications
Tap price pin
Bell icon
EXPLORE A HOME
11 · Property detail
Photos
12 · Gallery
Features tab
13 · Features & floor plan
Location tab
14 · Location
Mortgage
15 · Mortgage calculator
Speak to a specialist
Save home
SHORTLIST AND ADVISOR
16 · Saved homes
Compare
17 · Compare homes
Ask advisor
18 · Advisor profile
Message
19 · Advisor chat
Book viewing
20 · Book a viewing
Confirm viewing
VIEWING AND OFFER
21 · My viewings
Make an offer
22 · Make an offer
Submit offer
23 · Offer status
Accept counter
24 · Documents
Sign
25 · Sign agreement
Counter · revise offer
Sign & continue
CLOSE AND ACCOUNT
26 · Reservation deposit
Pay deposit
27 · Reservation confirmed
Profile tab
28 · Profile
Settings
29 · Settings & security
30 · Sell with AURELLE
Sell or value a property


AURELLE
A home worthy of your story.
Your private advisor, always on call.
Welcome back.
Verify it's you.
Tailor your search.
Discover homes beyond the ordinary.
Welcome home.
Saved homes.
My viewings.